

Powerful Web Task Force

Shaping the Future of Apps on the Web

What is it about?

The Powerful Web Task Force was an effort announced by TAG members Dan, Lea and Sangwhan during TPAC 2023:

https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1-1Q-2206wTjWadU0NtXozEWyGZbnaz1ABHCWL_MCNaM/edit

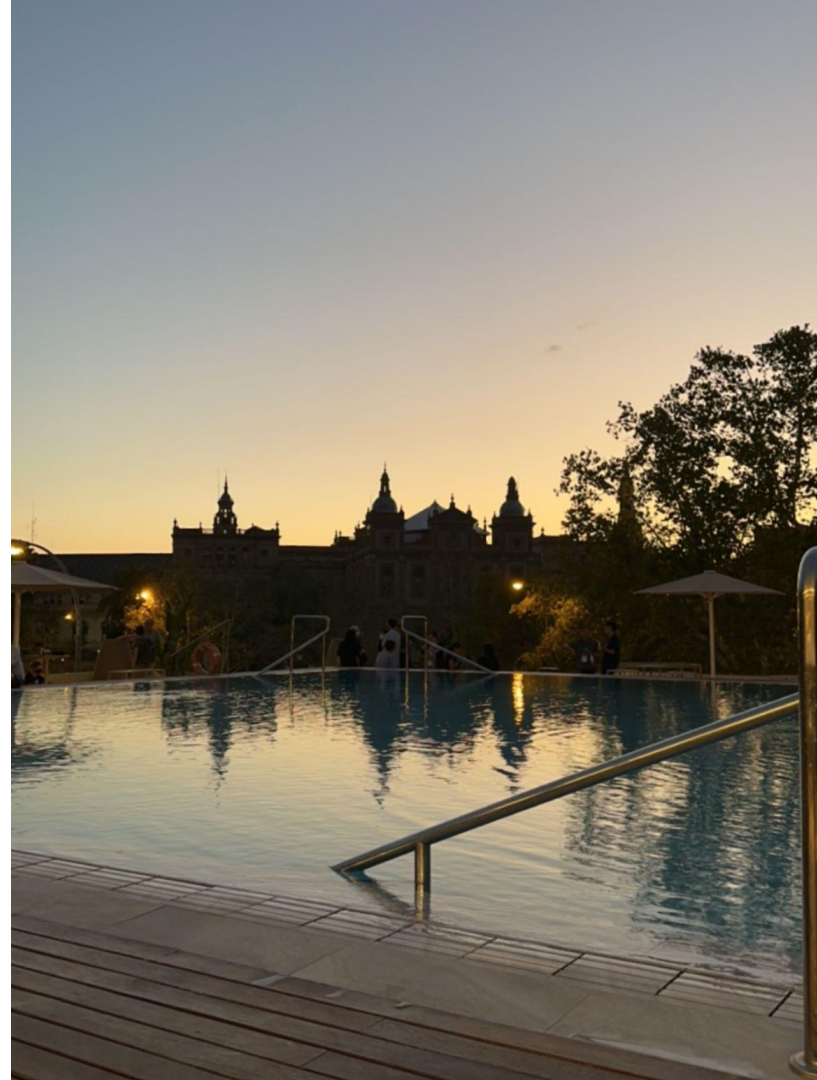


What is it about?

Their analysis: Capabilities that are basic on native are still not fulfilled by the web platform.

Goal: Bridge the gap between native apps and web apps.

Prior Art: Cordova/Capacitor, Electron/Tauri, Isolated Web Apps (IWA), MiniApps, Project Fugu, ...



Christian's opinion

The TF was not started.

The “powerful web” situation hasn't significantly changed since 2023.

Conflicts regularly appear along the “capabilities line.”

I believe it would be worthwhile to relaunch this effort.



Scope of the task force

- Investigate the possibility of having an additional “powerful” context
 - In this context, what kind of capabilities should be stripped or de-webbified?
 - Is the user installing the app considered a grant for more power?
- Identify a set of common denominator capabilities served by current bundled renderer runtimes
- Scope out proposals to provide such capabilities
- Sketch out a path forward to scope and reduce permission fatigue
- Propose a process for faster iteration to incubate and standardize powerful capabilities (also, deprecate failed ideas quickly)
- Develop consensus positions around the above

Non-goals (for now)

- Address discoverability and installation (in a sense of how it is implemented for each platform, store) - app stores
- Promote any single member's vision of the future of the web platform
- Payment integration and license management
- Packaging formats (to be discussed, as this ties into the long-living offline problem)

Reception (things I heard in the room)

“Nice! Finally!

“We don't want to be “forced”
by the TAG into
implementing capabilities
we don't support.

Priority of Constituencies

“User needs come before the needs of web page authors, which come before the needs of user agent implementors, which come before the needs of specification writers, which come before theoretical purity.

What's already happening?

- Conversations between Apple, Google, Microsoft, Mozilla about installation of web applications (WebApps WG effort)

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- Ensure all vendors are on board, but also developer representatives.
- Start with the vision of members for the future of the web platform and try to develop a consensus position.

Possible action items:

- Change or keep the name?
- Venue? WebApps + TAG as reviewers? TAG-only?
- Which TAG members would be interested in joining?